

Linux On Old Hardware — Cheat Sheet

Last-minute recall reference. For the reasoning behind each row, see [LESSON.pdf](#) or the interactive tour.

TASK	COMMAND / RULE
List enabled boot services	<code>systemctl list-unit-files --state=enabled</code>
Disable a service now + at boot	<code>systemctl disable --now <service></code>
List running processes	<code>ps aux</code>
Graceful vs forceful kill	<code>kill <pid></code> (SIGTERM) vs <code>kill -9 <pid></code> (SIGKILL)
Change permissions / ownership	<code>chmod</code> / <code>chown</code>
Real-time CPU/RAM per process	<code>top</code> / <code>htop</code>
Disk space per filesystem	<code>df -h</code>
Why did something fail?	<code>journalctl</code>
Machine feels slow, high swap	Memory pressure — disk-backed swap is far slower than RAM
Fix a broken package install	<code>apt --fix-broken install</code>
Repair a broken boot	Rescue media → <code>mount</code> root partition → <code>chroot</code> in → fix → <code>exit</code> → <code>reboot</code>